



Notes

Feb 16, 2026

Internal Sync on Hershey OCP

Invited [Bill Venella](#) [Grayson Kass](#) [Will Watson](#) [Jason Anderson](#) [William Lehman](#)

Attachments [Internal Sync on Hershey OCP](#)

Meeting records [Transcript](#)

Summary

Grayson Kass and Bill Venella initiated the discussion on the Hershey account, focusing on data anomalies that indicated potential overconsumption of subscriptions, with Will Watson explaining that the quarterly refreshed account data for products like OCP, Ansible, and Rail revealed the overage. Reviewing the OCP consumption data, Bill Venella and Grayson Kass noted that the customer had potentially overconsumed by about 20 cores, leading Will Watson to propose a strategic, proactive discussion on subscription true-up ahead of the year-end renewal to avoid a negative compliance perception, a concern echoed by Bill Venella. The participants, including Bill Venella, Will Watson, and Grayson Kass, agreed to approach the customer with a standard check-in talk track, co-terming any true-up with the upcoming renewal, and listening to the customer first to understand the overage's nature, while also avoiding the negative talk track with Jason until his return.

Details

- **Introductions and Role Clarification:** Grayson Kass and Bill Venella started the meeting with casual greetings, and Grayson Kass clarified their role as the Sales Engineer (SE), supporting Will Watson, who is the Sales Representative (rep) on the account team. The topic of discussion for the meeting was the Hershey account ([00:00:00](#)).
- **Discussion on Data and Account Refresh:** Will Watson joined the call and explained that the data team sends a list of refreshed top accounts every quarter, focusing on products like OCP, Ansible, and Rail, which have telemetry data. The file sent to Bill Venella analyzes the active subscriptions against the amount of cores checking in, which can sometimes be skewed by Cloud Packs or migrations between product versions ([00:04:11](#)).

- Initial Assessment of Account Overage:** The file indicates that the account is potentially overconsuming subscriptions, although Bill Venella was initially surprised since they described the customer as generally honest about their subscriptions. Grayson Kass asked if anyone had the account's EBS number to review the details ([00:05:15](#)). Bill Venella shared an example where the customer honestly reported purchasing the wrong Rail subscription for an MEES system and sought to convert it to Rail with Satellite, reinforcing their perceived honesty ([00:06:14](#)).
- Analyzing OCP Consumption Data:** Will Watson directed the team to review the OCP summary tab in the shared file, which showed fluctuations in deployed cores versus purchased cores ([00:07:17](#)). Based on the data, Bill Venella observed that core counts ranged from 174 up to 192, and Grayson Kass noted that the overage appeared to be a longer-term issue stretching back to 2024, not just a single upgrade ([00:09:03](#)) ([00:11:57](#)). They confirmed that the customer had purchased 154 subscriptions, making the potential overage roughly 20 cores, if they use the maximum count of 174 ([00:10:25](#)).
- Strategic Approach to Subscription True-Up:** The team noted that the customer's OpenShift renewals happen at the end of the year, based on a three-year renewal cycle. Will Watson suggested positioning the conversation as a standard, proactive check-in ahead of the renewal to help the customer understand their growth since the last deal, rather than a compliance engagement ([00:13:13](#)). They agreed that addressing the issue now would be less painful for the customer than waiting, as the true-up amount would grow over time ([00:14:13](#)).
- Mitigating Compliance Perception Risks:** Bill Venella emphasized that approaching the customer with a compliance-focused discussion could lead them to rip out the product, as they have done with competitors in the past ([00:15:04](#)) ([00:19:57](#)). Will Watson outlined a recommended talk track for the conversation, focusing on the need for a checkpoint since one was missed the previous year, with any necessary fixes co-termed to the upcoming renewal. Will Watson also mentioned the increased industry-wide focus on compliance reviews as context, but agreed with Bill Venella not to start the conversation with that approach ([00:16:09](#)).
- Next Steps and Internal Coordination:** Bill Venella committed to including the subscription discussion as part of an upcoming roadmap update with the customer, emphasizing that an open dialogue is currently in place. They requested that the team hold off on the negative talk track when speaking with Jason, who is currently unavailable due to a family emergency, but whose input is needed to understand the customer's subscription activity and upgrades ([00:09:03](#)) ([00:18:09](#)). The team agreed to listen to the customer first to identify the nature of the overage (e.g., unused environment) before assuming an outcome ([00:19:57](#)).

Suggested next steps

Grayson Kass will take a closer look at the data to validate the number of cores purchased versus cores deployed.

Bill Venella will let Will Watson know if anything comes up in the meantime.

Bill Venella, Will Watson, and Grayson Kass will sync up with Jason at the end of the week or next week to prepare him for the talk track.

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Transcript

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Internal Sync on Hershey OCP - Transcript

00:00:00

Grayson Kass: Hey, Bill.

Bill Venella: Hey. Hey,

Grayson Kass: How's it going?

Bill Venella: Grayson. Good afternoon. How are you?

Grayson Kass: Pretty good. Good. Last call of the day. Let's get I think Will's about to jump on.

Bill Venella: Last call of the day.

Grayson Kass: He was on the previous call with me,

Bill Venella: Okay.

Grayson Kass: especially since he's the one who set it up, I

Bill Venella: He did.

Grayson Kass: think.

Bill Venella: He did. Yeah. Do you work for Will?

Grayson Kass: Yeah. Basically,

Bill Venella: What What's your role?

Grayson Kass: will just think of it just like the account team. If he's the rep, I'm the essay.

Bill Venella: Okay.

Grayson Kass: Just for for compliance.

Bill Venella: Got it. Okay. Good. Well, good to meet you.

Grayson Kass: good to me as well. So, it looks like it's Hershey

Bill Venella: Hershey is the is the topic for today.

Grayson Kass: going to claw back all the all the money I spent on their chocolates.

00:02:29

Bill Venella: Yeah. Did you spend any yesterday?

Grayson Kass: I did on Saturday. You are right on that.

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah.

Grayson Kass: I ate I ate her leftovers on Sunday. So So you're right on that one.

Bill Venella: Oh, the uh the Reese's cups are are a

Grayson Kass: Same. I we like the um the weird derivatives of Reese's cups that they have been making.

Bill Venella: favorite.

Grayson Kass: Like the peanut butter jelly or the Oreo Reese's has been a good one,

Bill Venella: Oh, wow. Yeah.

Grayson Kass: but the potato chip one, I'm sorry, is my favorite. A lot of people don't like that one.

Bill Venella: So, is that a uh is that a peanut butter or

Grayson Kass: It's a Yeah, it is a peanut I think Reese's Peanut Butter Cup,

Bill Venella: Uhhuh.

Grayson Kass: but within the chocolate they have like shredded uh potato chips.

Bill Venella: Oh, wow.

Grayson Kass: It is pretty good.

Bill Venella: I'm going to have to look that one up because I uh that's that's another favorite.

00:03:15

Grayson Kass: It is pretty good.

Bill Venella: Potato chips.

Grayson Kass: But I'm also very simple. I like the old Mr.

Bill Venella: Nice.

Grayson Kass: Goodler.

Bill Venella: Yeah, they uh they have a lot of the old uh old brands.

Grayson Kass: I think I'm the only one who buys it at the local gas station.

Bill Venella: You may be Hey,

Will Watson: Hey, Bill.

Bill Venella: Will.

Will Watson: How's it going? Sorry, I uh we ho Grayson, we hopped off that last call. My my nanny was calling me saying,

Grayson Kass: I

Will Watson: "I I need some advice what to do with a kid." I'm like, "Oh gosh, that's that's why we hire you." Like,

Grayson Kass: was You took the words out of my mouth.

Will Watson: yeah. Anyway, um, cool. Uh, let's see. Are we waiting on anybody else,

Bill Venella: No.

Will Watson: Bill?

Bill Venella: Uh Jason has an issue that he has to deal with personally, so he's not going to be joining.

Will Watson: No problem. Um, okay. So, yeah, I'll uh I'll kick things off, I mean, and let you ask questions.

00:04:11

Will Watson: And again, this is I don't think I gave you too much detail in the email cuz it's, you know, sometimes it's the easiest just to have a call about it. So, I'm glad that we set something up. Um, but every quarter, our data team sends a list of refreshed accounts that are like the top for the quarter on rail. Usually, it's re uh OCP and Anible are the three main products. um since telemetry data exists for those and you can easily see like all right what's checking in compared to what what is active um so that's what that file that I sent is basically an analysis of is what do they have active against the amount of cores that we're checking in um sometimes things can skew that on telemetry um if they have cloud packs which I don't think they have cloud packs is that correct

Bill Venella: No, they do

Will Watson: yeah And then also migration from one version to another can sometimes be the case.

Bill Venella: not.

Will Watson: Grayson, is there anything else that might skew that?

00:05:15

Grayson Kass: There's a few things, but I'd have to look into an account before I could really call it.

Will Watson: Yeah. Yeah. So, yeah, that's basically it. Um, it's not saying like this is definitely like this is what they're over, but usually a good indication of it. It's worth another conversation, especially with you guys to see if you've had any suspicion or uh checkpoints. um if they've been growing proactively, maybe just not fast enough according to the records we're seeing on our side,

Bill Venella: Yeah. Uh I have no like so they're pretty

Will Watson: right?

Bill Venella: honest uh around uh subscriptions. So that's that's why I was a little shocked that they were on the list. Um but yeah, I think you just So I'm looking at what you sent me. I'll I'll share it.

Grayson Kass: And just so I could get up to speed really fast or just do a quick glance, does anyone have the account number EBS?

Bill Venella: I think they're right here. Am I sharing that?

00:06:14

Will Watson: Did I not copy you on the email, Grayson, that had the attachment?

Grayson Kass: If you did, I didn't see it.

Will Watson: Okay.

Grayson Kass: That's just my fault.

Will Watson: Yeah, it must have been last week.

Grayson Kass: Do you know which one of those customer numbers is the one we're really running? I know it's all of them, but like where most of their subscriptions is, would you say?

Bill Venella: Who are you asking?

Grayson Kass: Oh yeah.

Bill Venella: I don't I don't That would be a Jason

Grayson Kass: Yeah. No problem.

Bill Venella: question. So, so let's go back to the question again, Will. Right. So, you're so let me let me share with you my example first. Right. So, uh, the business bought some rail last year for an MEES system. Uh, they bought the wrong rail. Uh, we've been working with, uh, it who's our main Red Hat counterpart for for all buying who wanted to upgrade the rail from just base rail to base uh, to rail with satellite.

00:07:17

Bill Venella: And uh again they they've been very honest on hey uh we did not purchase this correctly. We want to resolve this. We want uh we want to use satellite with with that rail. So uh can we convert it? So again that's that's why I'm I'm shocked by uh that they would be in a situation where they're over uh consuming So

Will Watson: Yeah.

Bill Venella: yeah, uh there is there no so that that that's a good question, but uh they all roll up into uh the same VP of IT

Will Watson: Okay, let's go to the OCP summary tab on the file

Bill Venella: uh OCP data Oh,

Will Watson: the two more tabs over.

Bill Venella: sorry.

Will Watson: Grayson, what do you think's best for you to validate the number?

Grayson Kass: Um, I'm doing it right now.

Will Watson: Yeah.

Bill Venella: Course purchased versus course deployed.

Will Watson: So, it looks like they're not consistently over. It's like up and down. Up and down.

Bill Venella: Yeah, it could be could be an upgrade. I mean, we we will definitely find out.

00:09:03

Grayson Kass: for that long though. Let's just assume February 24. Let's just call that a start date. Then February 26. It's a lot of up and down for it just to be one upgrade. I do get what I'm

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah.

Grayson Kass: saying.

Bill Venella: Well, the 192 down to 174, but uh yeah, the 176 is consistent with their first year. Then they moved up to Yeah. So, we're going to we're going to have to redo this when when Jason's back. Uh I mean, he's he's the one who definitely connects with them on on the subs and what they're doing from an upgrade perspective that he he could be able to answer that question. And then I guess where are you getting the 212 from? Right. So if uh if 20 November 25 to February 26 is 174, what how do you get 212? It's from Oh,

Grayson Kass: It's taking the top from July 24. That's what that is.

Bill Venella: got it.

Grayson Kass: I think it's just taking max count.

00:10:25

Bill Venella: Got it.

Grayson Kass: I don't think

Bill Venella: It's taking max count. Okay.

Grayson Kass: it's

Bill Venella: Got it. Make sense.

Grayson Kass: all right. So,

Bill Venella: 24 is when uh they did the original

Grayson Kass: customer

Bill Venella: implementation. So that could be the reason for the inconsistency right uh to the 212. But we still need to answer if they only purchased uh 154, how do they have 20 over? Right? Is that is that the question we're trying to solve for?

Grayson Kass: I believe so. Give me one second. Do you know how much they like currently have subscribed to save me time?

Will Watson: All the way over to the right,

Bill Venella: of Yeah,

Will Watson: it should say active subs on this thing.

Bill Venella: that's where I am right

Grayson Kass: Oh, sorry. I'm on another screen. I'm coming

Will Watson: Yeah.

Bill Venella: now.

Grayson Kass: back.

Will Watson: 70 and seven premium and standard. Oh, wait. Actually, premium premium.

00:11:57

Grayson Kass: Yeah.

Will Watson: One with run one with run times and one

Grayson Kass: So 70×2 is 140 14 154,

Will Watson: without.

Grayson Kass: right? Yeah,

Will Watson: Yeah.

Grayson Kass: it looks like they're over on land. Just if we're looking at this, I pulled back six years. I'm about to share my screen. So, from what we have, I can see why it looks like they're over. So, they've been over. This is 2024. Then you just do spice. Don't even count like the high points. just keep a baseline. Looks like they've been over for a hot minute.

Bill Venella: Mhm.

Grayson Kass: So, if they did an upgrade, it was in October. So,

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Grayson Kass: I agree with that. So, right here was probably when they did upgrade, but then they went right back to 174.

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Grayson Kass: So, it's definitely worth a look, I guess.

Bill Venella: It's definitely worth a look.

Will Watson: Yeah. The other thing is like the goal of this would be, you know, downplaying the conversation like how well I guess are they on a three-year renewal or a one-year renewal?

00:13:13

Will Watson: When do they do the renewal?

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Will Watson: That's important.

Bill Venella: So that that's a good question. I think uh they are up for the open shift renewals uh is at the end of the year. Actually they do re every year but they did a three-year for open shift which renews at the end of this

Will Watson: Perfect.

Bill Venella: year.

Will Watson: That's what I thought. So that that helps us because they haven't really and I mean have they been buying onesie twzies between the last three renewal and Okay.

Bill Venella: No.

Will Watson: So that's key, right?

Bill Venella: No.

Will Watson: So like what we could do here is we could play it as a standard like process of you know midway through um you know really technically we should have done it last like Q3 right but we're behind uh check just to make sure we're well ahead of the renewals so that they can um you know have plenty of time to understand how they've grown since the last deal. Right? That's how I would position it.

00:14:13

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Will Watson: It's not like we're out to get you like and then all we have I mean it's not a lot a lot of effort on their end to just go to the console or run OCP uh commands to pull the core counts and just be like hey great like thanks for you know focusing on this as a priority for this week. Looks like you're off by a little bit. Why don't we go ahead and take care of that now or we need to take care of that now. Not why don't we need to take

care of that now. Um, and we'll just co-term it to your renewal so that at time of renewal you can have more time to understand what your needs are going forward, right?

Bill Venella: Yeah,

Will Watson: I think that so yeah,

Bill Venella: I think that makes sense.

Will Watson: I mean this could be like a multi-year trueup already. So like the longer that you wait, the more painful it is for them because it's more time that goes by with them on a like off on what they need to true up on, right?

00:15:04

Bill Venella: Right.

Will Watson: So yeah, I think that's that's all like good for us. It's early in the year. um they have all year till their three-year renewal. But um the conversation like this probably goes better with us being like on the back end to start um because it you don't want it to be like a compliance perceived as comp of compliance engagement,

Bill Venella: No,

Will Watson: right? Um yeah.

Bill Venella: they will rip us out if it if it's that they've they've uh Yeah, they they they don't like the um

Will Watson: So that's that that's why we're it's Yeah.

Bill Venella: the

Will Watson: So like I feel like we could you know we're aligned on the strategy. It's just a matter of you know I guess you want your essay to take a closer look. That's great.

Bill Venella: Yeah,

Will Watson: Um but if we want to have another call with him cuz like I you know we certainly get

Bill Venella: I have one hit.

Will Watson: involved on these type of telemetry things if the customers not willing to cooperate with you guys.

00:16:09

Will Watson: Um there's some good talk tracks on like I think what I just outlined is probably the simplest like you know in you know sense of well okay there's a call to action which is they haven't done a checkpoint in the last two years on a threeear

renewal and we can't um you know really we should be doing that once a year. So like okay we missed last year but at least we have plenty of time to do it this year. Um and then we'll anything that needs to be fixed we'll just take care of it up till the renewal when they'll do it again like in a year right? So, uh, but the other advantage like keep in the back of your head if it gets to like

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Will Watson: we don't want to do that or we don't we don't have to do that or whatever. Um, you know, it's in you guys are running it right at some point in the year. And I mean, I'll take a step back and say this is the first year I've done compliance for 10 years and I've never seen it this like aggressive ever to start the year off in the sense that there's like 820 accounts that Global is trying to do a full third party review with.

00:17:15

Will Watson: And so customers that have the ability to work their account team and correct stuff proactively, granted we still would absolutely be expecting a true up on it, right? But you still are in control of what the discount is, right? If if a compliance review was to be initiated, now there's a third party involved. Now there's a MSRP component involved perhaps and audit fees on top of that and potentially reinstatement fees. There's a lot more things that they wouldn't want to be in play if if they were to not take this this type of thing seriously,

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah.

Will Watson: right?

Bill Venella: But that Yeah. We we won't start the conversation that

Will Watson: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah.

Bill Venella: way.

Will Watson: I'm just trying to set the tone for like customers that just try to pretend like, you know, they don't have time for it or they'll do it at the time of renewal when they haven't bought in 3 years. I'm just setting the stage for like that's not good good answers if that's how they, you know, handle the call that you guys have with them,

00:18:09

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah. I mean,

Will Watson: right?

Bill Venella: I think uh the these guys are we have an open dialogue right now and uh

we're working on um coming to them with uh you know roadmap updates so this can be part of that discussion.

Will Watson: perfect. Okay,

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Will Watson: cool. Grayson,

Bill Venella: Yeah.

Will Watson: you have any other

Bill Venella: I I wanna I want to include so let me get back to

Will Watson: thoughts

Bill Venella: you. So Jason's daughter was in a uh a wrestling event and uh she got hurt. She got injured and she's at the hospital. So hopefully by the end of the week or maybe next week uh we can

Will Watson: Sorry to hear that.

Bill Venella: sync up with him and you know and then prepare him for the talk track. I you know don't don't share the negativity with him. He uh he seems to repeat things. I I don't want to I don't want to scare off the customer if we don't have to.

00:19:08

Will Watson: Okay.

Bill Venella: Right. That's my

Will Watson: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. So I Yeah. I I I guess there's Yeah,

Bill Venella: point.

Will Watson: I've seen it all. Right. So I appreciate that. I completely can um understand that that context. So yeah, I um I think we're in a good spot and downplaying it key. You guys have the relationship. Uh we have time on our side. three year renewal like all the variables are lining up to be pretty um straightforward thing we could do here. Do you think now I'll just ask you this. Do you think that that they'd be cooperative with like doing the console stuff? It it doesn't take a long time and then we're like, "Oh, it looks like you guys are off. Let's true that up." Would they be upset if we were seeking like a one-year backdated true up or something? You know, would they perceive that as like that's not going to fly or are they like, "Oh yeah, you're right. We should have done that last year kind of thing.

00:19:57

Bill Venella: Yeah. I mean, so before we uh we determine, you know, what uh what the outcome is, let's let's listen, right? Um uh I maybe it is an unused environment uh or,

Will Watson: Yeah.

Bill Venella: you know, somebody didn't turn off, but let's rather than determine the outcome, let's let's identify what uh what the overage is before we

Will Watson: Yep. Got it.

Bill Venella: uh make an assumption, right?

Will Watson: Sounds

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah. I mean,

Will Watson: good.

Bill Venella: it's not a big account, but uh they're good people. Uh we have a good dialogue, and I know uh when presented with these situations in the past, I mean, they've shared with me that they just rip out uh they've ripped out competitors because of uh these discussions. So, uh I don't want to be in that situation, right? So, that's what I'm defending against. It's not uh it's not settling up, right? I mean, if uh if we find out uh they're over uh we we'll we'll definitely work towards that.

00:21:14

Bill Venella: I just don't want to get in a situation where they now they have 11 months to rip us out, right? Or 10 months to rip us out.

Will Watson: Yeah. No, I I understand. I mean, I guess the only caution I would say is if that's their motto with like any vendor, then um the other way to look at would be like are they saying that they're not they don't take, you know,

Bill Venella: No,

Will Watson: alignment with the value like Yeah.

Bill Venella: they definitely do take accountability. And that's why I'm saying,

Will Watson: Yes.

Bill Venella: you know, they uh they do take accountability.

Will Watson: Yeah.

Bill Venella: It's just uh they don't like the evasive approach of, hey, uh that's that's our sales tactic, right? Oh, you're not growing. All right. Well, we'll just find something uh and and bill you, right? Uh we're not going to do that.

Will Watson: Got it. Okay.

Bill Venella: But yeah, I mean I think this is uh this is good data. I did I didn't uh I didn't see the other tabs will so that that that was helpful going

Will Watson: Okay, perfect. Yeah, well,

Bill Venella: through.

Will Watson: we'll uh connect again here next week hopefully um at the latest and let us know if anything comes up in the meantime.

Bill Venella: Yeah. No, I appreciate you setting this up and uh yeah, we'll we'll get this figured out. Right. Thanks, guys.

Transcription ended after 00:22:40

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